

CHRISTOPHER VAN DER MERWE

IT SUPPORT TECHNICIAN

Technical Support • Help Desk • Desktop Support • Remote Support
Breyten, Mpumalanga | 064 688 0556 | chrisvdm@yahoo.com
Portfolio: portfoliochrisvdm.github.io/PortfolioChrisvdm/

Professional Summary

Hands-on IT Support Technician with more than a decade of project-based freelance experience providing paid technical support to private clients. Experienced in diagnosing, repairing, upgrading, and maintaining desktop and laptop computers, deploying Windows operating systems, configuring Microsoft 365 and Google Workspace, and supporting users with hardware, software, and networking issues. Backed by over ten years of leadership and customer service experience, I combine practical technical knowledge with excellent communication and analytical problem-solving skills while continuing professional development in software development and cybersecurity.

Professional Highlights

- 10+ years of paid freelance IT support
- 80+ desktop and laptop systems repaired or upgraded
- Windows XP–11 support and deployment
- Microsoft 365, Microsoft Office & Google Workspace
- 10+ years leadership and customer service
- 18+ completed Codecademy courses

Technical Skills

Operating Systems: Windows XP/7/8/10/11

Hardware: Desktop & Laptop Repair, PC Assembly, CPU, RAM, SSD/HDD, GPU, Motherboards, PSU, BIOS/UEFI

Software: Microsoft 365, Office, Outlook, Google Workspace, Windows Deployment, Driver Installation

Networking: Routers, Home Networks, Printers, Static IP, Remote Desktop, TeamViewer, AnyDesk

Development: HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, C#, Lua, Visual Studio Code

Professional Experience

Freelance IT Support Technician (Self-Employed) | Jan 2014–Present

- Delivered paid IT support services to private clients.
- Built, repaired and upgraded 80+ desktop and laptop computers.
- Installed and configured Windows XP–11.
- Configured Microsoft 365, Office, Google Workspace, routers, printers and remote support tools.
- Performed hardware diagnostics, BIOS configuration and SSD migrations.

Senior Restaurant Manager | Various Hospitality Roles | 2005–2014

- Managed operations, trained staff, maintained customer service and reporting.

Contract Boilermaker | Steinmüller | 2006–2007

- Industrial fabrication, maintenance and repairs.

Professional Development

Completed Codecademy courses:

HTML, CSS, Intermediate CSS, Flexbox & Grid, Responsive Design, Box Model & Layout,

Variables & Functions, Accessibility, Browser Compatibility, Transitions & Animations, JavaScript, Intro to C#, C#, Lua, Introduction to Cybersecurity, Choosing a Career in Tech, Leading in the Age of Generative AI, Navigating AI Ethical Challenges and Risks.

Currently Studying:

- Full-Stack Engineer Career Path (43%)
- Introduction to Ethical Hacking
- Prompt Engineering: Generative AI for System Hacking

Education

Hendrina Combined School – Secondary Education

Additional Information

Code 10 Driver's Licence • Fluent in English & Afrikaans • Available for remote work and international business hours